2026-10-25 — Shabbos שמונה עשרה: Why Seven, the ישמח משה Machloikes, and the Kedushah of Eretz Yisrael

Independent review · read fresh from the HTML alone, no transcript consulted · 25 October 2026 · 14 Cheshvan 5787 · final (Sefaria-corrected) draft

1.Overall Read

A nine-section write-up of roughly 8,100 words (abstract and body, before the apparatus) with a twenty-one-note *Mareh Mekomos*. It is really two shiurim stapled together. The first (II-VII) asks why the Shabbos Amidah has seven berachos, offers the Bavli's "hurry" reading and the Yerushalmi's "no personal requests" reading, then moves to the Tur's three Shabbasos, the wedding model, and the Rashi / Rabbeinu Tam story of ישמח משה. The second (VIII-IX) is a different subject altogether, the Shabbos morning Kedushah: Masechet Soferim, Pirkoi ben Baboi and the Genizah, the Chasam Sofer, and the Eretz Tzvi's proposal that אדיר וחזק is a copyist's expansion of אופנים וחיות. A dedication for the shul's late Rav opens it (I).

The hard problems are six. (a) **"The Rav" means two different people in Section I.** The speaker is "the Rav" throughout, and in I the late Rav of the shul is also "the Rav," "our Rav," and "the Rav's son." A first-time reader cannot tell who is davening in Heaven. (b) **The title question gets the least space.** Section V, "Why Seven?", is 171 words, while IV runs 1,783 and VIII 1,624. The reader leaves without a settled answer to why seven. (c) **The two halves never meet.** Nothing says why a talk on the Amidah turns, with a few minutes left, to Kedushah. (d) **The body presents as quotation or fact what the notes cannot find.** The Tanchuma lines, the Yerushalmi of Rav Abba, the Soferim claim and Eretz Tzvi are all given flatly; the notes

then say "UNCERTAIN" or "differs from the Rav." (e) **Digressions.** Miami and the 11:00 finish, the war in Gaza, scooters on Shabbos, and the room's banter occupy perhaps a tenth of the text. (f) **The ending is a shrug.** The shiur closes on "the rabbis don't have the courage" and a request to run in for a berachah, directly after a passage in which the Rav praises the Chasam Sofer for refusing any change.

2.What Works

- **The "Where am I?" opening of III.** The Rav's own confession of davening the wrong berachah, the chuppah example, and Rav Abba's gratitude that the body bows at Modim make a real, human entrance into a technical Gemara. It is the best writing in the piece.
- **The Bavli versus the Yerushalmi (IV).** The two readings of מפני כבוד שבת (people in a hurry, or no petition on Shabbos) are laid out under their own sub-headings, and the objections from the room (Mi Shebeirach, Rachem, Tehillim, Eliyahu) are the objections a reader would raise. The line "two ways of being a מחלל," the letter versus the spirit of Shabbos, is quotable.
- **The Yaavetz's Sheva Berachos (V).** "Every Shemoneh Esrei on Shabbos is another Sheva Berachos" is the most memorable single sentence about why seven, and it is placed well.
- **The Tur's three Shabbasos and the wedding model (VI).** The three-line list of the middle berachos with their times, followed by the four-stage wedding, is easy to hold in the head, and the wry remark about modern weddings reversing the order gives it life.
- **Rashi and Rabbeinu Tam (VII).** "Our *heilige* Rashi never said ישמח משה in his life" is a real hook, and the grandfather / grandson turn is a clean story.
- **The Pirkoi ben Baboi narrative (VIII).** The Genizah, the letter, the

emissaries and "a Judaism of שמד" read as a connected account with a cause (no minyan, so they forgot) and an outcome.

- **The Eretz Tzvi (IX).** The question "who is *they*?" in אז בקול רעש גדול, the comparison with Yotzer Or, and the proposed abbreviation א' ו' ח make a genuine puzzle with a clever solution, and the text is displayed pointed so the reader can see the gap.
- **The notes are candid.** The "Flag" lines say plainly when the Rav's locus is wrong or unfound (Tanchuma parsha, Rav Abba, Soferim).

3.Where It's Weak or Could Be Sharper

Disambiguate "the Rav" in Section I. "The Rav" is the speaker; the shul's late Rav is "the Rav," "our Rav," and (in the note) "the Rav." The sentence "He tells the room what he told the Rav's son, Reb Moshe, yesterday" and the Aharon HaKohen paragraph cannot be followed without knowing which Rav is meant. Call the late Rav "the shul's late Rav, Rabbi Yehoshua ben Menachem Mendel HaLevi" at first mention and "our late Rav" after, and never "the Rav" for him. In a book, the whole section (394 words, with "Bernie," "Reb Simcha," the bris, the calendar exchange) should be a three-line dedication.

Answer the title: why seven. The headline question is answered in V in 171 words, by three answers that are not weighed against each other: the seven appearances of the Name in Psalm 92, the Yaavetz's Sheva Berachos, and (from IV) Tehillim 119:164. Add one sentence naming all three, say whether the Rav prefers one, and let V open VI rather than sit between two much longer sections.

The logic at the end of IV is muddled. The "halachic upshot" says the Yerushalmi's Rishonim hold there is an *issur*, that the Yerushalmi might tell a person who began a weekday berachah to stop, "but the Bavli does not go with that reason," and then "That's why we have only one berachah." The last sentence does not follow: both readings yield seven berachos. State the upshot as a clean two-column contrast: *Reading one* (a convenience, so the obligation survives and one finishes the berachah) versus *Reading two* (a prohibition, so

one might stop). Then say plainly which reading the Gemara in Berachos 21a fits.

Section VII mixes two different questions. "Where does Yismach Moshe come from?" is answered by (1) the Midrash of Moshe and Pharaoh and (2) the Matan Torah reading. "Why Shabbos morning and not Friday night?" is answered by (a) the guest's תלילה הולך אחר היום argument and (b) "the Torah was given in the morning." The text says "two readings in the Tur," then tells the Pharaoh midrash, then a guest's proof, then "there's another reason," then "so there are two ways of reading." A reader cannot tell which answer belongs to which question. Restructure as: Question A (what is the joy?) with its two answers; Question B (why morning?) with its two answers.

Kedushah is introduced as a new subject without a bridge. VIII opens "With a few minutes left, the Rav turns to the Kedushah." Add a two-sentence bridge: the Shabbos Amidah differs from the weekday not only in the middle berachah but also in the Kedushah, and both differences are the same story, Eretz Yisrael's distinct liturgy. Right now the reader does not learn why the connection matters until Pirkoi.

Two explanations for Eretz Yisrael's omission of weekday Kedushah, not reconciled. First: it is "the ancient *minhag*... since the times after the Tannaim, like the Amoraim went to Bavel." Later, on Pirkoi's account: a decree of שד kept people from shul, so they forgot. These are different periods and different causes. Say that the first is the Rav's description of what Soferim records and the second is Pirkoi's polemical explanation for it, and state who is arguing with whom.

Chronology is scrambled in the calendar paragraph. It says the calendar dispute lasted two years "in the 900s," that Rav Saadia Gaon wrote letters, and that "it originated in the time of Rav Yehudai Gaon and his disciple Pirkoi." Pirkoi is earlier than the 900s by the body's own reckoning (the "eighth century"). Either drop the dates or give them with a clear "the Rav says."

Digressions to cut or shrink. The Miami years and "I finished by 11:00" (about 250 words in IV); the war in Gaza aside (II); "the kiddush club" and the

dessert jokes; the scooters on Shabbos and "the rabbis should have the courage to make changes" (IX). The scooter paragraph is also the only place the shiur touches a live communal controversy, and it is stated vaguely enough to mislead. If kept, it needs a sentence saying what the Rav's point is: that the Chasam Sofer's example is a reason for caution, not a position on any specific question.

The ending. The last paragraph has the Rav praising the Chasam Sofer for not changing an iota, then reporting the Eretz Tzvi's view that the text is a mistake, then saying nobody fixes it "because the rabbis don't have the courage." That reads as an accusation that undercuts the previous section. The Rav's sentence "I'm not saying you should change it. I'm just saying it to appreciate that sometimes things crept into our siddur" is a fine closer. End there, and cut the courage line and the request to run in for a berachah.

Unexplained internal references. "We have it on record," "when we went on the trip to Pressburg," "when we learned the מקדמה in the Machzor," "when the shul learned Nishmas," "the shul had given an entire shiur on Shmuel HaKatan." A reader of the book will not have those shiurim. Replace with a bracketed pointer to the relevant chapter of the series, or drop.

Participants and names. The text names Bernie, Reb Simcha, Rav David Chai HaLevi, Reb Yehoshua, Reb Yehuda, Reb Chaim Yishai, Rav Elchanan, Reb Biyatz, Alan, Nadav and a guest ("Rav Adnan"), and uses "a congregant" ten times. None is needed. Keep the guest only if he can be identified and described accurately in print; otherwise "a guest from Eretz Yisrael." "Reb Chaim Yishai had meant to say it" and "Reb Biyatz interrupts with a *gevald*" should go entirely, since the exchanges that follow are "partly inaudible."

4.Factual / Citation Concerns

"The Chida" among "old Rishonim" (VIII). The text has "Old	ראשונים

struggled to understand. You should see the א"	חיד"The Chida

(eighteenth century) is an Acharon. Fix to "later authorities" or "Acharonim."

Ofanim and Chayos in Yeshayahu (IX). The text says the Rav "points to Yeshayahu, where the Ofanim and Chayos say the great Kedushah and the Seraphim answer." Note 21 itself says Yeshayahu 6 is the Seraphim and Yechezkel 1 the Ofanim and Chayos, and leaves it "not re-fetched."

The body should carry the correction. The natural source for קול רעש גדול is Yechezkel 3:12-13, where the Ofanim and "a great noise" appear beside ברוך כבוד ה' ממקומו. Quoting that verse in the book would give the Eretz Tzvi's proposal its natural support, and should be verified before it is added.

Soferim is reported as fact, and the note contradicts it (VIII, note

16). The body says Soferim records that Eretz Yisrael "never said Kedushah during the week," skipping it at both Shacharis and Minchah. Note 16 says the Sefaria text of Soferim has the reader not saying Kedushah *in the morning* while Kedushah *is* said at Minchah, which is a different pattern and not what the Rav says. The body should say "as the Rav reads Soferim," and the book needs a located text or the claim should be softened.

The Tanchuma quotations (IV, note 8). The Hebrew lines שאסור לו מצא שמחלל את השבת are in נזכר מעשיו ומיצר, ולאדם לתבוע צרכיו בשבת and צרכיו printed in the body as the Midrash's words. Note 8 reports that is absent from the Sefaria text and these sentences were not found. Print them as the Rav's gloss (or a different nusach), not as a quotation. The body also still says the Rav "calls the parsha Vaeira, the passage is

Vayera. See note" with no number, and "this week's parsha" is a

statement the book cannot keep.

"R' Tanchuma bar Abba, one of the Tannaim" (IV, note 8) and "a

named Rav Abba" (III, note 4). Both are amoraim by the notes' אמנא

own statement. The body leaves "as the Rav calls him" in one place and

nothing in the other. Make both "an early sage" or "an Amora."

Rav Abba at Modim (III, note 4). The Yerushalmi statement was not

located; Yerushalmi Berachos 1:5 has a different statement by Rebbi Abba

bar Zavda. A book cannot print "the Yerushalmi says" and then a note that

says it does not. Either a text is found or the passage is attributed to "a

statement the Rav cited from the Yerushalmi."

Rashi's motives (VII). The body has Rashi saying "in effect, לא ידעתי

what it is doing here, therefore I don't say it" and "Judge, will you know

better than Rashi?" The first is the Rav's reconstruction, not a source;

note 13 says no passage was located. The claim "none of Rashi's students

said it" and "in Jerusalem nobody said it" are also unlocated. Put these in

the Rav's voice, with "the Rav reconstructs."

The Tur's "two versions" (VII, note 14). The body says "There are

two versions in the Tur on how to understand | Note 14 says: ישמח משה

the Pharaoh reading is in Shemos Rabbah and that neither the Tur's

second reading nor the "Midrash Megilos" scrolls were located, and the

Tur at 292 mentions only the Matan Torah reading. The Tur's role should

be reduced to what the note verifies: three Shabbasos, and the Matan

Torah reading.

The Genizah and Pirkoi (VIII, note 18). The body repeats "two Scottish nuns," "in the years 738," and "almost 1,300 years ago." The note says the discoverers were the sisters Agnes Smith Lewis and Margaret Dunlop Gibson, not nuns, and that Pirkoi is usually dated to the early ninth century. The body should print the corrected facts; a note of correction is not enough for a book page. Also "Gaon Yaakov" for the yeshivah is "as heard" and unchecked.

The Eretz Tzvi (IX, note 21). The responsum is unlocated, and the author's identification ("the Kozhiglover Gaon, Rosh Yeshivah of the Chachmei Lublin," "about 85 years ago") is as heard. The note correctly says to print it as a שידוש only; the body should add a sentence that the Rav is relaying the proposal secondhand.

The Chasam Sofer (IX, note 20). "Writes somewhere in a teshuvah that nobody knows where אז בקול רעש גדול comes from" is a pointer to nothing. The note says no siman was given. The heading of IX ("Where Does Az B'kol Come From?") promises an origin, and the section's answer is only "nobody knows" plus a conjecture about a typo. Rename the section.

Berachos 21a and the Shulchan Aruch (III, note 3). The body is correct in outline. The Gemara's reasoning ("the Sages did not impose upon him in deference to Shabbos") is printed in the note but only paraphrased in the body as "a מנראדיקע סברא Print the Gemara's sentence in III; it is the text the whole shiur turns on.

Dates. 25 October 2026 = 14 Cheshvan 5787 (7 Cheshvan was 18

October), consistent with the previous week's page. The yahrzeit is

"Tuesday" in the body and 16 Cheshvan in note 1; the recording's "ט'

וחשון ז" is almost certainly a misheard וחשון ט", which the note could say

outright. The abstract says the shiur is "before the second yahrzeit" while

I says it is "on Tuesday" with a bris "on the day of the yahrzeit":

harmonize.

Footnotes and the "Flag" lines: what a book edition must resolve or move to endnotes

> All twenty-one notes carry a "VERIFIED," "UNCERTAIN," or "CORRECTED" line.
> Sorted by what the flag says:

- **Verified:** 2 (Berachos 28b), 3 (Berachos 21a, SA 268), 5 (Menachos 43b),
  > 7 (Yerushalmi Shabbos 15:3), 9 (Tehillim 92 and 119:164), 11 (Tur 292),
  > 15 (Shabbos 86b), 17 (Berachos 21b). Eight notes; reduce to clean one-line
  > citations.

- **Corrected the Rav:** 8 (Vayera, not Vaeira; wording). One note, but the
  > body must also change.

- **Oral report or custom:** 1 (yahrzeit), 12 (wedding model), 20 (Chasam
  > Sofer), 21 (Eretz Tzvi). Print as attributed reports.

- **Genuinely unresolved:** 4, 6, 10, 13, 14 (partly), 16, 18, 19. Eight or nine

notes where a library visit is needed or the claim should be softened.

Problems that apply to the apparatus as a whole:

- **Platform language.** "Sefaria" and "Sofer.ai" and "Plaud summary" appear in the notes; a book cites the work and place, and the editorial log is a separate document.

- **Voice.** Many notes are a mixture of source and editorial self-talk ("kept as the Rav's report," "as heard on the recording"); split each into a clean citation and a log line.

- **Body text that is itself note-like.** "(On the recording he calls the parsha ... See note.)", "(as heard on the recording; the spelling is to be confirmed)", "(partly inaudible on the recording)", "Reb Biyatz, as the Rav pronounces it" all belong to the web edition only.

- **Note 1 versus Section I.** The note is longer than the sentence it explains and mixes a date problem, a source problem, and a Plaud correction.

- **Dangling pointer.** "See note." in IV has no number.

5.Small Polish Suggestions

- **Transliteration to unify:** *Machloikes* (title) versus *machloket* (IV, VII); *Shabbasos* versus *Shabbosos*; *Mareh Mekomos* (footer heading) versus *Mareh Mekamos* (project name); *Rabbi Ephrati* (page) versus the folder's *Efratti*; *Chassidishe*; *Pirkoi / Pirkoy*; *Kozhiglov*.

- **Yiddish and slang.** "Bocher hazetzer," "מוראדיקע סברא," "amol dreyen oys," "gut ongeshikhert," "Vest a vos? A child in the cradle!" The last two should be glossed or cut. "איבער חכם, a wise guy" is fine.

- **Hebrew pointing policy.** The one quoted Kedushah text is pointed;

the Yom Tov berachah quoted in VII, the three middle berachos in VI, and the Rav Abba bowing are not. Point every full quotation or none.

- **Sub-headings.** IV (1,783 words) and VIII (1,624) are the longest; IV is sub-headed well, VIII has four sub-heads but the "Babylonia against Eretz Yisrael" sub-section still holds five distinct ideas. Add one before "the letter and the emissaries" (present) and one before the Soferim reason.
- **The abstract** (295 words) names eleven topics. Trim to: the question (why seven), the two readings, the three Shabbasos and the wedding, Rashi / Rabbeinu Tam, and the Kedushah puzzle.
- **The words "the Rav"** appear about fifty times; "Rav" plus a name another eighty. In the book convert the lomdus (IV, VII) to direct exposition and keep the reporting voice for the stories.
- **Hebrew phrase "I find it hard to believe that Moshe Rabbeinu didn't know."** The Rav's doubt is interesting and should stay, but add whose midrash it challenges.

Consolidated recommended edits (for the Sefer Edition rewrite)

1. Rewrite Section I as a three-line dedication; reserve "the Rav" for the speaker.
2. Expand V into a short, complete answer to "why seven," listing the three reasons and the Rav's preference.
3. Restate the end of IV as a two-reading contrast and say which reading Berachos 21a fits.
4. Restructure VII into two questions with two answers each; reduce the Tur's role to what is verified; mark Rashi's reasoning as the Rav's reconstruction.
5. Add a bridge between the Amidah half and the Kedushah half; rename IX to match what it contains.

6. Move the corrections from the notes into the body: Vayera, "Chida is an Acharon," Ofanim in Yechezkel, "not nuns," Pirkoi's dating, and the Tanchuma wording as the Rav's gloss.
7. Qualify the Soferim claim in its first sentence and reconcile the two explanations of the omission.
8. Remove names, banter, the war, Miami, and the scooters; keep the Rav's sources.
9. Print the Gemara's own sentence from Berachos 21a and, if verified, Yechezkel 3:12-13.
10. End on "I'm just saying it to appreciate that sometimes things crept into our siddur."

6.Bottom Line

> *A lively, learned and unusually well-sourced write-up, with a genuinely good opening (the Rav's own "Where am I?"), a clear Bavli / Yerushalmi contrast, a memorable Rashi / Rabbeinu Tam story, and a clever final puzzle in the Eretz Tzvi. As a web page it works, and its apparatus is honest. As a book chapter it needs a clearer first page (two Ravs), a proper answer to its own title question, a bridge between its two halves, a tidier Section VII, and the corrections that currently sit only in the notes (Chida, Ofanim, nuns, Tanchuma wording, Soferim) moved into the body. Trim the digressions and end on the Rav's own reflection rather than on the courage line, and it would stand as a Sefer Edition chapter.*

Independent editorial review of the English write-up only. The reviewer read the HTML as a stranger would and did not consult the recording, the transcripts, or the earlier reviews. *caveat lector*.